

Student Writing Sample

One day as I was walking my dog down the block he randomly frees himself and runs away. As I am chasing after him I see him digging in the dirt. Then when I am overlooking him to see what he is doing I realize he has picked out a bone. When I examine the bone it had come to my attention that this was the bone of a human being. At that moment I realized that this was the job for a forensic anthropologist like myself.

The first thing I did was carefully collect the rest of the remains at the crime scene. I put them in the plastic bag that I was planning to use for my dog. Once I had gathered all the bones and jewelry, even some bloody cloths I immedietly went to the lab to check this out.

Once I got to the lab the first thing I must find out is the sex, age, race and height. This biological profile as explained in the chapter, "Giving Faces to the Lost," is usually the start of an investigation. I soon discovered that the bones belonged to a 14 year old girl who was a 5' 3 hispanic. Then there's an examination for tattoos, piercings, scars, etc. not much was found except two ear piercings in this case. We still didn't know the identity of the female victim. It was necessary to hand over the skull to a forensic artist for facial reconstruction. As he worked on constructing what was most likely be the face of the girl, I went to get some help from a blood specialist to examine the blood spatter on the earth I found.

With the face model that the facial artist made, we asked for help to post pictures of the facial model on neighborhood bulletin boards and in stores. As results came back we were able to get a match on the face of the girl from two store clerks and contacted the family. They told us that they still believed she was on her camping trip that's why they didn't file a missing child. Eventually I got some help from forensic odontologist to find the dental records of this young lady. This was to confirm the family's identification of Alvarez. Finally, as the DNA of the blood cam back it turned out to the murder's blood. Overall the story was that he was stabbed in the leg by the girl when she was trying to defend herself. He was sentenced to jail for life for the murder of Alexis Alvarez.

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